

TRAINING & DEVELOPMENT

INTRODUCTION

Training and development describes the formal, ongoing efforts that are made within organizations to improve the performance and self-fulfillment of their employees through a variety of educational methods and programmes. In the modern workplace, these efforts have taken on a broad range of applications—from instruction in highly specific job skills to long-term professional development. In recent years, training and development has emerged as a formal business function, an integral element of strategy, and a recognized profession with distinct theories and methodologies. More and more companies of all sizes have embraced "continual learning" and other aspects of training and development as a means of promoting employee growth and acquiring a highly skilled work force. In fact, the quality of employees and the continual improvement of their skills and productivity through training are now widely recognized as vital factors in ensuring the long-term success and profitability of small businesses. "Create a corporate culture that supports continual learning," counseled Charlene Marmer Solomon¹⁵ in *Workforce*. "Employees today must have access to continual training of all types just to keep up.... If you don't actively stride against the momentum of skills deficiency, you lose ground. If your workers stand still, your firm will lose the competency race."

CONCEPT OF TRAINING

It is about developing employees as an individual to make them capable and confident in their jobs, and consequently in their life. Thus it is an organized process for increasing the knowledge and skill of the employees. Consequently it is a process aimed at changing the behavior in such a way that the consequence would be useful for the upliftment of the organization.

According to Wayne F Cascio, —Training consists of planned programme designed to improve performance at the individual, group, and /or organizational levels. Improved performance, in turn, implies that there have been measurable changes in knowledge, skills attitude, and/or social behavior.¶

Training is considered as a tool for HRD. Training has immense potential in transfer and utilization of latest technical know-how, leadership development, organization of people, formation of self-help-groups, mobilization of people as well as resources, empowerment of resource-poor rural mass, entrepreneurship development, etc., which are considered essential components of HRD.

According to C B Memoria, —Training is a process of learning a sequence of programmed behavior. It is application of knowledge and it attempts to improve the performance of employee on the current job and prepares them for the intended job. Training is a short term process utilizing a systematic and organized procedure by which non managerial personnel acquire technical knowledge and skills for a definite purpose. Training refers to instructions in technical and mechanical operations, like operation of some machine/equipment. Training is for a specific job related purpose¶

Training is about developing people as an individual and helping them to become more confident and competent in their lives and in their jobs. The learning process is at the core of training and the ways of and opportunities for learning are numerous and varied.

CONCEPT OF DEVELOPMENT

Development is related to enhancing the conceptual skills of the employee, which helps individual towards achieving maturity and self-actualization. In the words of Michael Armstrong — Employee development, often referred to as human resource development (HRD) is about the provision of learning, development and training opportunities in order to improve individual, team and organizational performance.

Development is defined by Alan Mumford²⁰ as an attempt to improve managerial effectiveness through a planned and deliberate learning process. According to Bernard M Bass & James A. Vaughan

Development implies the nature and change induced among employees through process of education and training. In the words of Harold Koontz and Cyril O. Donnel Managerial development concerns the means by which a person cultivates those skills whose application will improve the efficiency and effectiveness with which the anticipated results of a particular organizational segment are achieved.

—In the field of human resource management, training and development is the field concerned with organizational activity aimed at bettering the performance of individuals and groups in organizational settings. It has been known by several names, including employee development, human resource development and learning and development.‖ Rosemary Harrison

As Michael Armstrong observes, —Employee development, often referred to as human resource development (HRD) is about the provision of learning, development and training opportunities in order to improve individual team and organizational performance‖ Efforts are made to develop employee so that they achieve their full potential for growth. Employee development programme include learning, education and training. Learning relates to a relatively enduring change in behavior taking place as a consequence of practice or experience. Education refers to development of the knowledge required for varied activities of life rather than for one particular activity. Training is planned and systematic change behavior through learning. Training enables employees to accomplish the level of knowledge, skills and competence to perform their job well.

NEED FOR TRAINING

As Price has observed, a training need exists when there is a gap between the present performance of an employee or group of employees, and the desired performance. Growing business performance is a journey, not an end. The success of business operations depends upon the ups and downs of the employee performances. Hence, the HR managers started looking for the methods to boost the performance and efficiency of its workforce to carry out the work today, and to train them for meeting tomorrow's goals. Training programmes were developed many years ago, but now-a-days, it has become a crucial factor in companies with certain objectives in mind. Training and development practices should boost up performance and develop the skills, knowledge and expertise of the employees.

The vital objective of training is to build-up right ability and capability in the labor force so that they can perform to meet the needs, wants and expected returns of the employers.

The need for Training may generally arise for the following-

- To improve the efficiency of employees

- To reduce wastage of time and money,

- To have quality output,

- To bring down supervision

- To have preventive maintenance,

- To achieve optimum performance,

- To boost morale of employees,

- To prepare workforce for future challenging work,

- To reduce absenteeism,

- To bring down the grievances,

- To build career by personal growth,

3.3 TRAINING OBJECTIVES

According to Saiyadain, the objectives of training differ according to the employees belonging to different level of organizations. The basic objective of training, however, is to establish a match between man and his job. This training is designated to improve the knowledge, skills and attitude and thus, equip the individual to be more effective in his present job or prepare him for future assignment. However individual's growth should not be taken as an end. From this point of view of an organization, individual's growth is a means to organizational effectiveness. The principal objective of training and development division is to make sure the availability of a skilled and willing workforce to an organization. In addition to that, there are four other objectives: Individual, Organizational, Functional, and Societal.

Individual Objectives – They help employees in achieving their personal goals, which in turn, enhances the individual contribution to an organization.

Organizational Objectives –

They assist the organization with its primary objective by bringing individual effectiveness. Functional Objectives – They maintain the department's contribution at a level suitable to the organization's needs. Societal Objectives – They ensure that an organization is ethically and socially responsible to the needs and challenges of the society.

Following can be briefly summarized as training objectives.

- To create constant awareness in the minds of all sections of employees of the mission of the industry, its objective and goals.

To encourage self-development to achieve organization goals with a sense of belonging and commitment to organization and thereby ensuring development of a proper work ethos in the Industry and fostering of team spirit.

To identify the training needs of the entire personnel in industry in keeping with the corporate plans and in consultation with the user departments.

To impart knowledge and skills necessary for performing the job efficiently and effectively and to keep the employees to acquire necessary conceptual, technical, human and managerial skills in the areas of decision-making and problem-solving.

To make available in adequate number sufficiently trained manpower to meet the diverse needs of a rapidly growing industry.

To organize special training programmes to improve employment opportunities as well as career prospects of persons belonging to SC/ST, minorities, handicapped, exservicemen, etc.

To organize training activities as aids to:

- o Career Planning and growth
- o Succession planning.

To educate and equip the employees to respond to the expectations of customers, and to accept responsibilities to attain a sense of achievement

To achieve effectiveness of training through tapping the in-house training facilities as well as sources available externally in a balanced manner so as to develop internal faculty support at all levels and disciplines.

STEPS IN TRAINING

In this section we will discuss the details of various steps you will follow for effective implementation of the training programme. We will follow the framework of before, during and after training to discuss various steps involved in training

- Identifying the problem
- Conducting training
- Follow up participants management and
- Setting broad aims and specific objectives of the training programme
- Listing the topics to be included in training
- Sequencing the topics and deciding the training methods
- Preparing for training